

Rural-Urban Divide

To strengthen Japans economy -> Government continued to support wealthy zaibatsu.
While this build cooperation and trust between government and big businesses -> it also resulted in wealth being concentrated in the hands of the big businesses - while workers and peasants continued to live in poverty.
-> Gap between rich and poor widened.

In the countryside -> Richest landlords, who made up about 2-3% of Japanese population -> did not work on the farms -> but lived on rent collected from tenant farmers.
These landlords -> lived in luxury and engaged in leisure activities -> such as visiting hot spring inns -> which was in sharp contrast to the poverty of the tenant farmers.

Growing unhappiness of poor towards wealthy -> led to uprisings such as rice riots of 1918.
-> these riots -> led by angry workers -> were triggered by a sudden increase in the prices of commodities -> especially rice -> which is a staple food.